UK Safety Camera Network Ltd

USCN-POL-003

Camera Security & Technical Safeguards

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1. Purpose and scope

This policy sets proportionate security and technical safeguards for cameras, recording media, networks, footage exports and associated administration operated by UK Safety Camera Network Ltd (USCN). It applies to USCN personnel, authorised installers and contractors, approved technical services and host-site arrangements.

USCN owns and controls the cameras and acts as controller for footage. Community hosts ordinarily supply a suitable location, electricity and internet connectivity; hosting does not confer ownership, footage access or administrator rights. This policy is read with USCN-POL-001, USCN-POL-002, the overarching legitimate interests assessment and each camera-specific data protection impact assessment (DPIA).

2. Accountability and reserved decisions

Authorised USCN technical personnel manage routine operational security, maintenance, monitoring and technical records. They may assess and accept residual technical risks within their remit. The DPO retains the expressly reserved authority to approve each camera-specific DPIA and operational commissioning, every network configuration, material privacy changes and material personal-data risks. Technical independence does not override these reserved approvals.

Hosts must report planned power or network works, unexpected outages, suspected faults, damage and tampering. They must not open, reset, move, modify or administer camera equipment. DPO-authorised, narrowly limited non-administrator host functions may be approved case by case; administrator privileges must never be provided to hosts.

3. Installation, inventory and lifecycle

Installation is carried out by USCN-authorised competent personnel or contractors. Before operational commissioning, the site, mounting, cable protection, weather suitability, network,

privacy measures, signage, storage, retention, credentials and available alerts are checked proportionately.

USCN maintains an equipment inventory identifying camera ID, manufacturer/model, serial or asset identifier, location, host contact, operating status and relevant configuration/firmware. Installation, replacement, relocation, repair, removal, loss and transfer are recorded. On decommissioning, disable recording, connectivity and remote services, revoke credentials, securely erase or lawfully preserve footage, update the inventory, confirm arrangements with the host and inspect the site for remaining equipment. Storage, reuse and disposal of removed equipment are determined case by case.

Physical installation, configuration and basic motion testing may precede commissioning. Commissioning means the DPO authorisation to begin operational service, after the camera-specific DPIA and technical checks.

4. Network security and access

Connectivity may use wired Ethernet or another method approved following assessment. Apply secure communications, suitable firewall and outbound-connection restrictions, unique credentials, network isolation and monitoring where supported. Camera connectivity on a host network must not permit access to unrelated host devices or data. Remote administration methods and every network configuration require DPO approval.

Use named individual accounts, least-privilege permissions, strong authentication, multi-factor authentication for privileged or remote accounts wherever supported, brute-force protections where available, and prompt access revocation. Shared accounts are prohibited except documented emergency technical arrangements. Default credentials must be changed. Secrets are held in restricted protected storage; compromised secrets are replaced promptly. Hosts receive no administrator credentials or recovery secrets.

Encrypt footage at rest, transmissions, exports, backups and stored credentials using supported methods, and apply proportionate alternatives where a particular camera lacks a feature. These capability constraints do not remove legal duties or reserved approval requirements.

5. External technical services

Manufacturer management platforms, remote monitoring or support services and update services may be approved following review of security, supplier access, data handling and location, permissions, retention/deletion and contracts. The DPO approves introduction or material change. Approval of a service does not permit suppliers to access live camera systems remotely; such live remote supplier access is prohibited.

Log successful remote administration, privileged activity, support interactions, outages, failed authentication and configuration changes to the extent supported by the actual system. Do not represent unavailable logs as active. Restrict or suspend insecure services or connections pending mitigation.

6. Recording, privacy and storage

Normal operation uses motion-triggered video recording. Audio recording, automatic number plate recognition (ANPR), facial recognition, automated cross-camera tracking, profiling or behavioural

analytics, and unrestricted remote pan/tilt/zoom are prohibited under this policy without exceptions.

Approve and document each camera field of view, relevant privacy masking, image quality, detection zones, sensitivity and proportionate pre/post-event capture. Review settings after material changes, complaints, faults or environmental changes. Recording schedules may be available on some models but are assessed in the camera-specific DPIA.

Approved storage consists of local camera media, encrypted local storage where supported and USCN-controlled network video recorders. Cloud recording storage is prohibited. Routine footage is kept for no more than 31 days and automatically overwritten or deleted, with shorter periods where practical. Test retention before commissioning and apply approved retention holds only under USCN-POL-002 and DPO authorisation. Secure deletion, media disposal and technical limits are managed proportionately.

Where power, a functioning local SD card and correct configuration remain available, local recording continues during internet outages. Cameras may email alerts to a designated USCN mailbox for supported events such as tampering, suspicious logins, storage problems and stopped recording; functions differ by model.

7. Footage access, exports and evidential integrity

Access to recordings is limited to designated personnel under case-specific DPO authorisation and documented restrictions. Preserve original recordings, limit editing, deletion and export, maintain available access/handling records, ensure accurate camera time where supported and verify integrity using available metadata, checksums or equivalent measures proportionate to device capability and disclosure purpose.

Exports require DPO authorisation, minimum necessary scope, secure storage and transfer, records of who exported what and why, and applicable export-retention controls. When an edited or redacted copy is needed, preserve the original separately. USCN's process applies a first added timecode to an exported working copy before editing/redaction, then a second added timecode following redaction. The original camera timestamp is retained where available; redaction may obscure portions of the original or first added timecode. The timecodes assist temporal comparison but do not alone prove absence of alteration. Record transformations and identify the final copy as processed.

Cloud recording storage remains prohibited. Any temporary disclosure-copy delivery mechanism contemplated by USCN-POL-002 must be separately authorised, secured, time-limited and checked for consistency with this policy before use; it is not permission to store routine recordings in the cloud.

8. Maintenance, monitoring and vulnerabilities

Authorised personnel conduct risk-based firmware, camera-health, storage, network, privacy, physical and account checks. Updates are sourced from trusted providers and assessed for compatibility, security and privacy impact. Maintain recoverable configurations and rollback arrangements where supported, record significant updates, and recheck recording, security, privacy, alerts and retention afterwards.

Alerts are routed to a designated USCN email account where supported and reviewed periodically as staff availability permits; there is no promise of continuous or daily monitoring. Relevant tamper, login, storage, recording, offline and firmware events are triaged by severity, privacy implications

and operational impact. Significant alerts, investigations and actions are recorded. Hosts may report suspected faults or interference. USCN uses available device monitoring features without a separate requirement to document every unsupported alert capability.

Vulnerabilities are identified from manufacturer notices, camera alerts, maintenance findings, host/staff/public reports and approved service providers. Assess severity, exposure, privacy, availability, mitigations and actual device capabilities; document significant findings. Apply patches, configuration restrictions, network isolation, replacement, suspension or credential changes as appropriate. Prioritise critical or actively exploited issues urgently. Technical personnel may accept residual technical risks, but material privacy risks are escalated to the DPO. Security testing is proportionate, with specialist assessment when justified.

9. Physical protection and security incidents

Use secure mounting, protected enclosures/media and cables, weather-suitable equipment, prudent positioning, available tamper detection and appropriate equipment identification. Inspect at installation, following reported issues and through risk-based maintenance. Hosts report suspected interference but must not alter equipment.

Potential incidents include unauthorised access, footage loss/disclosure/alteration, malware, tampering, compromised credentials and unauthorised configuration changes. Report suspected incidents internally as soon as practicable and within 24 hours of discovery. Technical personnel manage immediate containment, including isolation, suspension, credential revocation, lawful evidence preservation, impact assessment, documentation and host coordination as needed. The DPO oversees personal-data breach assessment and privacy decisions, including whether and when the ICO or affected individuals must be notified under applicable law.

Before a compromised camera returns to service, resolve or adequately mitigate the cause, replace affected credentials, verify security/privacy settings, test recording/storage/connectivity and obtain the appropriate technical and DPO authorisations. Theft or destruction of equipment is treated as a security incident, including assessment of stored-footage exposure.

10. Outages, recovery and continuity

Plan for power, network, storage, hardware, software, tampering and host-site failures. Diagnose faults, coordinate with hosts where necessary, repair or replace equipment, recheck security/privacy/retention, test available recording, storage, connectivity and alerts, and document significant outages and restoration. Prioritise by safety, privacy, evidence integrity and operational impact.

Maintain recoverable configuration information where supported. Do not routinely back up footage unless specifically authorised; approved backups remain subject to applicable security and retention controls. Routine fault recovery requires proportionate technical checks and approval. Seek DPO reapproval where security or privacy risk materially changes.

11. Technical assurance and records

Before commissioning, consider inventory, approved network settings, credentials, privacy controls, recording tests, retention, storage, alerts, signage/DPIA, time accuracy and physical safeguards. Testing is proportionate to camera capabilities and deployment risks. Retain, as selected minimum assurance records, the camera-specific DPIA reference, DPO commissioning approval and material

technical limitations. Unresolved relevant risks must be assessed and mitigated before DPO approval.

Maintain ongoing records for incidents, available access logs, approvals, inventory and significant maintenance. Apply the existing USCN minimum 12-month audit-log retention requirement where applicable, and proportionate periods for other technical records. Perform risk-based assurance checks. Reassess following relocation, material view/privacy changes, network changes, changed functions, significant incidents or changed host arrangements.

12. Exceptions, implementation and review

Technical exceptions require risk assessment and authorisation by responsible technical personnel; DPO approval is required where privacy or expressly reserved matters are affected. Exceptions cannot override law or mandatory safeguards. Mandatory safeguards include camera-specific DPIA/DPO commissioning approval; DPO network/privacy approvals; prohibited surveillance features; no host administrator access; DPO-authorised recording access; maximum 31-day routine retention and no cloud recording storage; and incident reporting/statutory notification obligations.

Apply this policy before each new camera enters operational service. Review existing equipment on material change or assessment. The policy is reviewed when material changes or significant events occur, including incidents, technology, legal developments, deployment changes and significant complaints; no fixed annual review cycle applies.

13. Approval and publication

Approval authority: Data Protection Officer. Approval date recorded for this document: 19 October 2026. The effective date is the date of publication, which has not yet been confirmed. This draft should be checked for consistency with USCN-POL-001 and USCN-POL-002 before publication.

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